



AFI to hold coaches accountable for failed dope tests of athletes



In order to curb the doping menace, the Athletics Federation of India (AFI) has decided to take action against coaches whose athletes commit doping violations.

The AFI, following its discussions with various stakeholders for about six months, took this important decision at its executive committee meeting.

"Coaches of the athletes who are caught for doping and sanctioned will get a similar punishment. It is high time people were called out, named, and shamed," AFI president Adille Sumariwalla (**above**) said at a virtual press conference.

"We will suspend the coaches (who have coached dope offenders), we will inform departments concerned, and they will not be allowed to enter the stadiums. These people have to be removed from whatever posts they are holding.

"We had talks with various agencies regarding this. If the coaches take a share of the athletes' cash award, then they should also get the stick."

The AFI chief said now the athletes needed to declare their coaches' names on dope control forms, and all the coaches would have to be registered with the federation.

Y. B. SARANGI

INDIAN PLAYGROUND

SPORTOON



1 Olympic wrestler Vinesh Phogat criticised the Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) for not providing information about the trials format, "including the date, time and venue" with three months left for the Paris Olympics. Vinesh, who secured a quota place in the women's 50kg category for India, took to X to share her concern with a letter directed to the WFI and the Sports Authority of India (SAI). "I request the authorities to prioritise this matter and promptly announce the dates, time, venue and exact format for the trials officially," she said.

TEAM SPORTSTAR

2 Joshna Chinappa and Abhay Singh beat Rathika Suthanthira Seelan and Harinder Pal Singh Sandhu 10-11, 11-2, 11-9 in a 45-minute final to become the mixed doubles champions of the HCL National doubles squash championship. **The results (finals): Men:** Abhay Singh & Velavan Senthilkumar bt Rahul Baitha & Suraj Chand 11-4, 11-8. **Women:** Rathika Suthanthira Seelan & Pooja Arthi bt Janet Vidhi & Nirupama Dubey 11-3, 9-11, 11-1. **Mixed:** Joshna Chinappa and Abhay Singh bt Rathika Suthanthira Seelan and Harinder Pal Singh Sandhu 10-11, 11-2, 11-9.

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